Singapore Stock Market - Maybank Research 2026-03-18: Despite War Uncertainty, Valuations Have Support

> ## Singapore Market: Valuations Stay Supported Amid War Concerns
>
> - Historically, oil price shocks have had limited impact on valuations. We see any pullback as a fresh entry point opportunity.



Iran Crisis: In The Fog Of War

- We don't know how long the Iran Crisis would last.
    - In a "Short War" concluding in under a month, we see limited 1H26 earnings impact. In fact, Banks, NBFIs, REITs and Tech Manufacturing may have upside.
    - In a "Long War" with elevated oil prices, earnings downgrade risks increase – especially for Banks, Consumer, Internet and REITs.
- Historically, oil price shocks have had limited impact on valuations. We believe Singapore's "certainty premium" and domestic-resilience-led thematics should continue to attract flows amid volatility.

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Replay

Short War: No Material 1H26 Earnings Impact

- We see limited impact to EPS in 1H26.
    - Financials should remain resilient from safe-haven flows and stable NIMs supporting **OCBC (SGX:O39) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/o39-ocbc-bank/stock-info)** and **DBS (SGX:D05) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/d05-dbs/stock-info)**, while **SGX (SGX:S68) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s68-sgx/stock-info)** may see higher equities and derivatives volumes from increased risk management.
    - In Consumer **Thai Beverage (SGX:Y92) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/y92-thaibev/stock-info)** is likely the key underperformer given tourism sensitivity.
    - Industrials are mixed: **Sembcorp (SGX:U96) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/u96-sembcorp-ind/stock-info)** could be exposed to power price volatility, while **ST Engineering (SGX:S63) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s63-st-engineering/stock-info)** benefits from defence demand.
    - Internet (**Sea Grab**) remains operationally resilient, but could face margin pressure from elevated logistics costs.
    - REITs (**CapitaLand Integrated Commercial Trust (SGX:C38U) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/reit/c38u-capland-intcom-t/stock-info), Frasers Centrepoint Trust (SGX:J69U) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/reit/j69u-frasers-cpt-tr/stock-info), Lendlease REIT (SGX:JYEU) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/reit/jyeu-lendlease-reit/stock-info), Mapletree Logistics Trust (SGX:M44U) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/reit/m44u-mapletree-log-tr/stock-info)**) should outperform on yield defensiveness.
    - In Transport, **SIA (SGX:C6L) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/c6l-sia/stock-info)** and **SATS (SGX:S58) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s58-sats/stock-info)** could face near-term margin compression from fuel costs.
    - Tech manufacturing stands out, with **AEM (SGX:AWX) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/awx-aem-sgd/stock-info)**, **UMS (SGX:558) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/558-ums/stock-info)**, and **Frencken (SGX:E28) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/e28-frencken/stock-info)** supported by semicon demand and AI capex.

Long War: Higher FY26 Earnings Downgrade Risks

- We see downgrade risks to EPS in FY26E.
    - Financials may face pressure from weaker loan growth, higher credit costs and softer fee income; **UOB (SGX:U11) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/u11-uob/stock-info)**, **SGX (SGX:S68) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s68-sgx/stock-info)**, are most exposed, although EQDP could provide partial downside offset via directed liquidity.
    - Consumer is defensive but uneven: **Sheng Siong (SGX:OV8) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/ov8-sheng-siong/stock-info)** remains resilient, while **Thai Beverage (SGX:Y92) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/y92-thaibev/stock-info)** may be negatively impacted due to its discretionary consumption exposure.
    - Developers could outperform REITs due to cheaper valuations and value-unlocking potential.
    - Industrials are mixed: **Sembcorp (SGX:U96) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/u96-sembcorp-ind/stock-info)** should benefit from sustainable energy transition capex, while **ST Engineering (SGX:S63) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s63-st-engineering/stock-info)** may experience aerospace-related softness.
    - Internet names may become vulnerable to weaker consumption and higher logistics costs.
    - Plantations benefit from elevated CPO prices.
    - Transport downside is likely limited. **SIA (SGX:C6L) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/c6l-sia/stock-info)**and **SATS (SGX:S58) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s58-sats/stock-info)** should see better rerouting and cargo yields, while **ComfortDelGro (SGX:C52) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/c52-comfortdelgro/stock-info)** is cushioned by fuel indexation.
    - Tech manufacturing offers relative resilience, underpinned by structural demand for semiconductors and AI.

High Oil Price: Limited Impact On SG Valuations

- In the past 15-years, Singapore valuations have been resilient to oil shocks. Amid oil price hikes ranging from 26%-52% from start-to-peak, the STI (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/undefined/undefined) increased an average of 4.8%.
- We believe Singapore's structural 'certainty premium' (https://sginvestors.io/analysts/research/2026/01/singapore-market-outlook-2026-maybank-research-2026-01-12) should continue to play out under the themes of domestic resilience, safe-haven flows, policy reforms, capital returns and growing AI deployment.

Top Picks

- We see any market pullback as fresh entry opportunity. Top Picks:
  - DBS (SGX:D05) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/d05-dbs/stock-info),
  - Sea,
  - SGX (SGX:S68) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s68-sgx/stock-info),
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  - CDL Hospitality Trusts (SGX:J85) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/reit/j85-cdl-htrust/stock-info),

- Lendlease REIT (SGX:JYEU) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/reit/jyeu-lendlease-reit/stock-info),
- Coliwoo (SGX:W8W) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/w8w-coliwoo-hldgs/stock-info),
- Singtel (SGX:Z74) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/z74-singtel/stock-info),
- ST Engineering (SGX:S63) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/s63-st-engineering/stock-info),
- Frasers Centrepoint Trust (SGX:J69U) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/reit/j69u-frasers-cpt-tr/stock-info),
- Addvalue Tech (SGX:A31) (https://sginvestors.io/sgx/stock/a31-addvalue-tech/stock-info).

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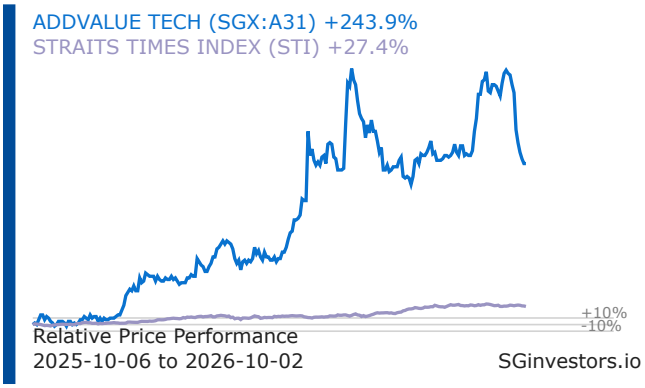
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